[Metric]
A-A-2905A
April 24, 1996
Superseding
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May 5, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PEN, RUBBERIZED BARREL
(RETRACTABLE & STICK / REFILLABLE)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all federal agencies.

1. **Scope:** This Commercial Item Description covers refillable rubberized barrel pens.

2. **Classification:**

Types:	I - Pen, Retractable II - Pen, Stick
Size:	A. Fine Point B. Medium Point

3. **Salient Characteristics:**

3.1 **Type I.** Pens shall consist of a round barrel coated with a rubberized type material (or equivalent), plunger with pocket clip, retraction mechanism, plastic or non-corroding metallic nose tip, a point containing a non-corrosive ball and a replaceable ink cartridge with a spring attached containing permanent ink. The overall length of this type pen shall be 14.0 cm ± 1.3 cm (5.5 ± .5 inches). The plunger or clip color shall indicate the color of ink.

3.2 **Type II.** Pens shall consist of a round barrel coated with a rubberized type material (or equivalent), removable plastic clip cap designed to fit snugly on both ends of the barrel, a point containing a non-corrosive ball and a replaceable ink cartridge containing permanent ink. The overall length of this type pen (without cap) shall be 14.3 cm ± 1.3 cm (5.6 inches ± .5 inches). The cap, tip or barrel color shall indicate the color of ink. The pens shall be furnished in the following colors: Black, Blue, Red.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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3.3 Manufacturer's name, trademark, writing point size or current commercial pen marking shall be exhibited on the pen. Placement of these permanent markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided they are prominently displayed.

3.4 Pens shall write smoothly by hand, while producing a legibly and permanent line. The line shall be reproducible by office copy machines which employ a visible light source in the reproduction process (xerographic).

3.5 Shelf Life. Pens shall have a minimum shelf life of eighteen (18) months after delivery and shall be capable of withstanding normal usage and handling and pass the performance characteristics tests as outlined in paragraph 5.4.

3.6 Workmanship. Pens shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects and imperfections which may adversely affect appearance, serviceability, and durability.

3.7 Ink Cartridge. Type I cartridge shall write a minimum distance of 750 meters (2460 feet). Type II cartridge shall write a minimum distance of 900 meters (2952 feet). The ink cartridges shall conform to the performance characteristics tests as outlined in paragraph 5.4.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practical, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5.2 Responsibility For Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier shall utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the government. The government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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5.3 **Examination & Testing.**

5.3. 1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. Objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.3.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in-process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing, they may be used when sampling for visual and dimensional conformance.

5.3.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.3.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional sampling shall be S-4 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective. The inspection level for performance characteristics testing shall be S-1 with an AQL of 6.5 percent defective. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

5.4 **Performance Characteristics Tests.** Testing shall be performed on components whenever practical as long as recordkeeping renders traceability. Unless otherwise specified tests shall be conducted in an atmosphere of twenty-one (21) degrees centigrade ± five (5) degrees centigrade and 50 % plus or minus 10% relative humidity. Test paper shall be in accordance with A-A-2804A, type III white bond paper having a pH value, average not less than 5.0 with a basis weight of 60 grams per square meter (16 pound, 17 x 22 - 500). A tolerance of 5% is allowable. Paper for the Machine Writing Test shall have an additional requirement of 160 - 140 seconds maximum smoothness on both sides using the Sheffield method per the most current TAPPI T538 test method. Alternately, paper conforming to JCP-O-60 can be used as an alternate source.

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5.4.1 Drying Time. Place a sheet of paper on a smooth, flat surface and partially cover with a second sheet of paper. Place a cylindrical weight, approximately 200 grams and about 25.4 mm (1 inch) on top of the second sheet of paper. Write a five letter word on the exposed portion of the bottom sheet, allow to dry 5 seconds. Immediately thereafter draw the top sheet and weight towards the top of the bottom sheet, across the written characters at a rate of approximately 10 cm per second. The writing should not smear when tested. Examine both sheets for compliance.

5.4.2 Machine Writing Test.

5.4.2.1 The machine tests shall be conducted on a Anja model W-10A, Hartley model W10-F, Minitek writing test machines or equivalent capable of testing pens or refills, with the following parameters set:

Writing Load:	0.981 N (100gF) to 1.225N (125gF).
Writing Angle:	75° ± 5° (non varying)
	or
	60° to 90° (continuously varying).
Writing Speed:	670 cm ± 10.0 cm / min. (22 ft / min.).
Writing Pattern:	Ellipse
Writing Surface:	Polished stainless steel.

5.4.2.2 The ink cartridge shall be subjected to the following condition and examined for compliance with the Machine Writing Test after being allowed to return to test temperature and humidity:

> Condition 1. 168 hours (7 days) at 60 degrees C ± 2 degrees C in a chamber with the ink cartridges suspended vertically (point down) at 85 to 90 % relative humidity.

5.4.2.3 After being subjected to the above condition, the ink cartridge shall be written for a minimum distance of 750 meters (2460 feet) for type I and 900 meters (2952 feet) for type II. Smooth writing shall start within the first 10 centimeters of the writeout without starvation or fluctuation of the line intensity. The written line shall maintain its relative color intensity throughout the writeout. Visual defects include blobs, skips, dotting and density variations of line intensity. The actual length of each visual defect shall be totaled for each cartridge and shall not exceed 1% of the written line.

6. Packaging:

6.1 Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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7. **Notes:**

7.1 **Source of Documents.** Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.2.1 **Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI).** Copies of T538 method may be obtained from TAPPI, Technology Park, PO Box 105113, Atlanta, Georgia, 30348-5113.

7.2.2 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

7.2.3 ANSI / ASQC Z1. may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control, PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

7.2.4 JCP-O-60 specifications may be obtained from Chief Paper Procurement Section, MMPP, US Government Printing Office, North Capital and H Street, NW, Washington DC 20401.

7.2.4 Federal Standards and Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at 490 L'Enfant Plaza, SW Washington DC 20407.

7.3 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN).** The following is a list of NSN's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSN's associated with the CID.

Retractable Pens:	**Stick Pens:**
7520-01-368-7771	**7520-01-357-6839**
7520-01-368-7772	**7520-01-357-6840**
7520-01-368-7773	**7520-01-357-6841**
7520-01-352-7309	**7520-01-357-6842**
7520-01-352-7310	**7520-01-357-6843**
7520-01-352-7311	**7520-01-357-6844**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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